

Day 23 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Different Modes of Agitation: Growth of Satyagraha and Militant Movements

READING MATERIAL

This topic covers the SPECTRUM of resistance — from Gandhi's non-violent Satyagraha (tested via specific named campaigns and their locations) to the militant/revolutionary strand (already covered via Bhagat Singh's HSRA in Day 22). Real exam evidence favors matching named Satyagrahas to their locations.

Q: Real exam: Match these movements to their locations — arrival of Simon Commission protest, No-Tax movement, Temple-entry movement, Neil Statue Satyagraha.

A: Simon Commission protest → Bombay. No-Tax movement → Bardoli (the Bardoli Satyagraha, 1928, against an unjust land-revenue hike). Temple-entry movement → Vaikom (the Vaikom Satyagraha, 1924-25, for lower-caste temple-road access). Neil Statue Satyagraha → Chennai (a TN-specific protest against a colonial-era statue).

Q: Real exam: Who organized the Vaikom Satyagraha, and where does this fit in his career chronology?

A: Thanthai Periyar organized it — chronologically, after he joined Congress but before he became president of the Tamil Nadu Congress Committee, and well before he later founded/led the Justice Party phase of his career.

Q: Real exam: Which book influenced Mahatma Gandhi's thinking?

A: John Ruskin's 'Unto This Last' (an economics/social-critique work that shaped Gandhi's ideas on simple living and economic justice, feeding into his broader Satyagraha philosophy).

Q: What was the Chauri Chaura incident (1922), and what was its consequence?

A: A violent clash on 4 February 1922 in Chauri Chaura (Gorakhpur district) during the Non-Cooperation Movement, where a mob killed 22 policemen. Gandhi held this violated the movement's non-violence pledge and called off the Non-Cooperation Movement as a result, believing the masses weren't yet sufficiently disciplined in Satyagraha.

Q: What was the Dandi March (Salt Satyagraha), and what did it trigger?

A: A 240-mile, 24-day non-violent march (12 March - 5 April 1930) led by Gandhi and 78 followers from Sabarmati Ashram to the coastal village of Dandi, Gujarat. On 6 April, Gandhi symbolically broke the Salt Act by making salt from seawater — this triggered the broader Civil Disobedience Movement, leading to over 60,000 arrests including Gandhi's own (5 May 1930).

Q: What was the Quit India Movement (1942)?

A: A mass uprising launched by Gandhi and Congress during World War II, demanding immediate British withdrawal ('Quit India'). Planned as non-violent, it turned violent in places after the British arrested Congress leaders almost immediately.

Q: How does the 'militant movements' strand differ from Satyagraha, and what's a key example already covered?

A: Militant/revolutionary nationalism rejected strict non-violence, favoring direct action (including armed resistance) against British rule — e.g., Bhagat Singh's Hindustan Socialist Republican Association (HSRA, covered in the Leaders II topic), which carried out the Saunders assassination and was tried in the Lahore Conspiracy Case.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Vaikom Satyagraha (temple-entry movement) took place in:

- A. Bombay
- B. Bardoli
- C. Vaikom ✓**
- D. Chennai

Explanation: Vaikom (Kerala). [medium, question-bank-2026]

2. The Bardoli Satyagraha is best known as a:

- A. Temple-entry movement
- B. No-tax movement against an unjust revenue hike ✓**
- C. Anti-statue protest
- D. Anti-Simon-Commission protest

Explanation: A no-tax movement (1928), against a land-revenue increase. [medium, question-bank-2026]

3. Who organized the Vaikom Satyagraha?

- A. Mahatma Gandhi
- B. Thanthai Periyar ✓**
- C. C. Rajagopalachari
- D. Bhagat Singh

Explanation: Thanthai Periyar. [medium, question-bank-2024]

4. Which book by John Ruskin influenced Mahatma Gandhi's thinking?

- A. Unto This Last ✓**
- B. The Stones of Venice
- C. Modern Painters
- D. Sesame and Lilies

Explanation: Unto This Last. [hard, question-bank-2022]

5. The Chauri Chaura incident (1922) directly led Gandhi to:

- A. Launch the Quit India Movement
- B. Call off the Non-Cooperation Movement ✓**
- C. Begin the Dandi March
- D. Found the Indian National Army

Explanation: He called off the Non-Cooperation Movement. [medium, web-research]

6. The Dandi March (1930) directly protested which British law?

- A. The Rowlatt Act
- B. The Salt Act ✓**
- C. The Vernacular Press Act
- D. The Arms Act

Explanation: The Salt Act of 1882. [easy, web-research]

7. The Quit India Movement (1942) was launched during which global conflict?

- A. World War I
- B. World War II ✓**
- C. The Korean War
- D. The Sino-Indian War

Explanation: World War II. [easy, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Compound Interest

READING MATERIAL

Compound Interest is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows TNPSC tests the standard CI formula, a useful SI-vs-CI shortcut, AND disguises CI as 'successive percentage change' word problems (depreciation, year-over-year growth) — recognize all three shapes.

Q: Formula: What is the Compound Interest formula, and the shortcut for the DIFFERENCE between SI and CI over 2 years?

A: Amount = $P(1+R/100)^T$, so CI = Amount – P. For exactly 2 years, there's a shortcut: $CI - SI = P \times (R/100)^2$. This avoids computing CI and SI separately when you only need their difference.

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.5,000 at 8% per annum.

A: Using the shortcut: difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 5000 \times (0.08)^2 = 5000 \times 0.0064 = \text{Rs.}32$. (Full check: SI = $5000 \times 8 \times 2/100 = 800$. CI = $5000 \times (1.08^2 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.1664 = 832$. Difference = $832 - 800 = 32$ ✓.)

Q: Real exam (2022): Find the compound interest on Rs.5,000 at 12% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A: CI = $P \times ((1+R/100)^T - 1) = 5000 \times (1.12^2 - 1) = 5000 \times (1.2544 - 1) = 5000 \times 0.2544 = \text{Rs.}1,272$.

Q: Real exam (2025): A sum becomes Rs.13,380 after 3 years and Rs.20,070 after 6 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

A: The amount after 6 years equals the amount after 3 years multiplied by the SAME growth factor again (since compounding is multiplicative): $(1+R/100)^3 = 20070/13380 = 1.5$. The sum itself: $P = \text{Amount-after-3-years} \div (1+R/100)^3 = 13380 \div 1.5 = \text{Rs.}8,920$.

Q: Real exam (2024): A motorcycle's value 2 years ago was Rs.80,000. It depreciates 4% in the first year, then increases 4% in the second year. Find the present value.

A: Apply each year's change as its own multiplier, in sequence — this is compound interest with a changing/mixed rate: $80,000 \times 0.96$ (first year, -4%) $\times 1.04$ (second year, +4%) = $80,000 \times 0.9984 = \text{Rs.}79,872$. Note the result is slightly LESS than the original Rs.80,000 — a decrease followed by an equal-percentage increase never fully cancels out, since the increase applies to a smaller base.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Find the difference between SI and CI for 2 years on a principal of Rs.8,000 at 5% per annum.

- A. Rs.18
- B. Rs.20 ✓**
- C. Rs.22
- D. Rs.25

Explanation: Difference = $P \times (R/100)^2 = 8000 \times (0.05)^2 = 8000 \times 0.0025 = \text{Rs.}20$. [medium, authored]

2. Find the compound interest on Rs.10,000 at 10% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

- A. Rs.2,000
- B. Rs.2,100 ✓**
- C. Rs.2,200
- D. Rs.1,900

Explanation: CI = $10000 \times (1.10^2 - 1) = 10000 \times 0.21 = \text{Rs.}2,100$. [easy, authored]

3. A sum becomes Rs.16,000 after 2 years and Rs.19,360 after 4 years on compound interest. Find the original sum.

- A. Rs.12,500
- B. Rs.13,000
- C. Rs.13,223 ✓**
- D. Rs.14,000

Explanation: $(1+R/100)^2 = 19360/16000 = 1.21$. $P = 16000/1.21 \approx \text{Rs.}13,223$. [hard, authored]

4. A machine valued at Rs.50,000 depreciates by 10% in the first year and a further 10% in the second year. Find its value after 2 years.

- A. Rs.40,000
- B. Rs.40,500 ✓**
- C. Rs.41,000
- D. Rs.39,500

Explanation: $50,000 \times 0.90 \times 0.90 = 50,000 \times 0.81 = \text{Rs.}40,500$. [medium, authored]

5. Find the compound interest on Rs.20,000 at 15% per annum for 2 years, compounded annually.

A. Rs.6,000

B. Rs.6,450 ✓

C. Rs.6,200

D. Rs.6,500

Explanation: $CI = 20000 \times (1.15^2 - 1) = 20000 \times 0.3225 = \text{Rs.}6,450$. [medium, authored]

Part C – General English: Poem: "Memories of My Dad" — Rebecca D. Cook

READING MATERIAL

A daughter's loving tribute to her father, recalling small everyday acts of paternal affection. Real coaching-site evidence tests theme, specific-line meaning, and one key figure-of-speech distinction (metaphor vs. simile).

Q: Who wrote "Memories of My Dad", and what is its central subject?

A: Rebecca D. Cook. Central subject: paternal affection and respect — a daughter's loving memories of her father's everyday acts of care.

Q: What does "He wasn't a hero known by the world" suggest?

A: He held heroic status only for his child — he wasn't famous or publicly celebrated, but was a hero specifically within his own family's eyes.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "My daddy was God."

A: Metaphor — a direct comparison WITHOUT using 'like' or 'as' (which would make it a simile instead). Calling him 'God' outright, rather than 'like God', is the key distinguishing feature.

Q: What does "Better than Santa" convey?

A: Happiness through genuine, heartfelt gestures — not about giving more expensive material gifts, but about the sincerity and warmth behind her father's care, which meant more than any Santa-style material giving.

Q: What does "I knew his voice before I could speak" communicate?

A: A strong emotional bond established in infancy — the connection with her father existed even before she had language, showing how foundational and early that bond was.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "Memories of My Dad" was written by:

- A. Emily Dickinson
- B. Maya Angelou
- C. Rebecca D. Cook ✓**
- D. Sarojini Naidu

Explanation: Rebecca D. Cook. [easy, web-research]

2. The poem's primary subject matter is:

- A. Natural imagery and seasonal change
- B. Youthful pastimes
- C. Paternal affection and respect ✓**
- D. Disagreement and resolution

Explanation: Paternal affection and respect. [easy, web-research]

3. "He wasn't a hero known by the world" suggests that the father:

- A. Lacked any admirable qualities
- B. Achieved nothing significant in life
- C. Held heroic status only for his child ✓**
- D. Actively rejected public recognition

Explanation: He was a hero specifically to his child, not publicly famous. [medium, web-research]

4. "My daddy was God" is an example of which figure of speech (as opposed to a simile)?

- A. Comparison using 'like' or 'as'
- B. Direct comparison without those words ✓**
- C. Giving human qualities to non-human things
- D. Repeated consonant sounds

Explanation: Metaphor — a direct comparison without 'like/as'. [medium, web-research]

5. The reference to being "Better than Santa" conveys:

- A. Superior material gifts

B. Supernatural present-giving ability

C. Happiness through genuine, heartfelt gestures ✓

D. A description of his clothing

Explanation: Happiness through genuine, heartfelt gestures, not material wealth. [medium, web-research]

6. "I knew his voice before I could speak" communicates:

A. A purely mental/intellectual connection

B. A strong emotional bond established in infancy ✓

C. His unusually loud voice

D. Her reluctance to communicate verbally

Explanation: A strong emotional bond formed from infancy. [medium, web-research]